

For a console, however, the hardware is always constant and thus the games look good enough to drool over without any issues like poor frame-rate. At the same time, this also means that there is no need to constantly upgrade the hardware, which allows you to save big bucks.

Further, consoles have traditionally been given preferential treatment over PCs, hence many games are either released exclusively for consoles (FIFA Street, Star Wars Episode 3) or are released on consoles months before they are released for the PC (GTA: San Andreas)

Sadly, consoles are not easily available in India. PS2 is the only console which is officially available and this invariably forces the true enthusiast to turn to the local grey market to get anything else.

The paucity of consoles naturally leads to a shortage of games, legal or illegal. And even if you were to find the game of your choice, sky-high prices are sure to send you home empty handed. Online gaming is a major let-down since you need to pay to join an online gaming service such as Xbox Live, and most of these services are not available in India.

As you can see, one can make a compelling case for both the PC and the console. While the jury is still out on console gaming in India, there is no doubt about its power and 'game-friendliness'.

If you want a machine that is a jack of all trades, the PC is your best choice. If you want a hardcore gaming machine-lack of legally available hardware and software notwithstanding-there is no doubt that the console is what you are looking for.

